THE TIDE REMEMBERS — Complete Story & Game Guide

A complete description of the game's story, world, characters, locations, mechanics, puzzles, horror events and endings, plus how the project is built. Written so that another person or AI can understand the whole game without playing it.

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1. One-paragraph summary

The Tide Remembers is a first-person psychological horror game (Godot 4.3, no combat). Maintenance technician **Elias Vale** is sent at night to **Vey Isle**, a remote North Atlantic island removed from the charts in 1972, to restore a dead weather station that has been sending a distress call for six years without power, and to transmit its final report. On Vey Isle **some sounds arrive before the things that make them** ("pre-echoes"). Elias hears his own footsteps before he walks, his own voice on the radio saying words he hasn't said yet. Something called **The Listener** walks the island, drawn to sounds — even sounds that haven't happened. Through the night Elias uncovers two secret 1960s programmes, **Project Pelagic** and **Project Morrow**, learns that a transmitter beneath the lighthouse heard "thirteen seconds of silence" and that **something answered**, and finally must choose what the island says next. Meanwhile **Suha**, the woman he loves, keeps calling him on the radio, softly telling him it is only a dream and asking him to come up to the light.

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2. The central idea: PRE-ECHO

- Normally a sound follows its cause. On Vey Isle, some sounds come **before** their cause.
- Pre-echoes have a recognisable signature in the game: a faint reversed swell, then the sound with a long dark tail (a dedicated audio bus with reverb).
- Examples in the game: Elias's footsteps follow him down the dock and take three more steps after he stops; a radio announces a conversation that he then overhears from another house; the settlement bell rings while it hangs motionless; a hatch in the lighthouse is heard grinding open before he pulls the release (pulling it is then silent); splashes in still cave pools; his own running footsteps coming down a cave gallery before he runs; the click of his own flashlight behind him.
- **The Listener hears pre-echoes too**: it walks toward where a sound *will* happen. That is the core of the stealth: hearing your future sound means the Listener is already heading there.

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3. Backstory (chronological)

When	What happened
14 Nov 1923, 02:58	Lighthouse keeper **Aldo Wren** logs that every sound on the island stopped for **thirteen seconds** (sea, wind, fog signal, his own heart).

When	What happened
15 Nov 1923	A storm drowns **Low Vey**, the lower fishing village on the east shore, in one tide. Survivors rebuild higher up as **Vey** (the settlement).
1968–71	**Project Pelagic**: Admiralty-funded early-warning research led by **Dr. Ruth Marrow**. Goal: predict storms and shipwrecks by detecting "pre-acoustic" signals that arrive before their causes. Weather station + a transmitter built beneath the lighthouse. Research ship **MV Pelagic**. Rule: never run the transmitter at full gain.
c. 1970–71	**Project Morrow**: the medical arm under **Dr. Edwin Morrow**, in an annex beneath the tidal caves. Twelve volunteers receive cochlear grafts tuned to the transmitter so humans can hear pre-echoes. All twelve hear them. Eleven vanish.
1971	The transmitter at full gain hears the thirteen seconds again — the island going silent — **and something answers**. **The Listener** appears. Residents vanish over a week; tea is left on tables. **MV Pelagic** sails toward the light because the island is "asking them to come closer"; her crew are taken below and "collected" by Morrow's people (ears removed). Other boats that come looking are wrecked on the west shore.
1971–72	**Tomas Kell**, the station's radio operator and Morrow's **Subject 12**, adapts physically: long arms, wings of skin, echolocation. He becomes a bat-like man who roosts in a rock cave near his old radio tower and comes out only when the bell strikes the hour. Before he lost himself he kept a diary and made a last recording, which now lies in his nest. Vey is removed from the charts.
Six years before the game	The dead weather station starts transmitting a distress call on 2.182 MHz with no power.
The game's night	Elias Vale arrives at 23:40. Morrow's subject list already names **Subject 13: E. VALE — "arrives by sea. He always does."** The parish-style register of the drowned and vanished includes his death time: **03:12**.

The Listener's origin is deliberately left partly unexplained. Marrow's final note says it was "here before Low Vey drowned"; the transmitter gave it a way to hear. It is built from what the sea took: soaked rope, fishing net, mineral growths, old ship parts. The annex holds a body grown into rope and netting, hinting that the vanished became part of it.

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4. Characters

Character	Role
Elias Vale	The player. Maintenance technician for Northern Maritime Services. Calm, tired, speaks in short thoughts (spoken + subtitled). The island has been "expecting" him: his voice is on radios and tapes before he speaks.
Suha	Elias's love on the mainland. Her voice reaches him on radios that cannot reach that far, and as soft whispers close to his ear. She says it's only a dream and asks him to come up to the light. In truth **the island learned her voice from Elias's memory** and uses it as a lure (Ending "The Light").
The Listener	The main threat. Tall humanoid shape of wet rope, netting, mineral shards and maritime fragments (a split buoy on one shoulder), a caged head of iron bands with no face. Hears noise and pre-echoes; sees poorly; never passes a doorway; will not enter a room with a **white ring** painted on its door.
Tomas Kell	Station radio operator, Morrow's Subject 12. Now the **bat-man boss** in Blackwood: hangs asleep in his roost; emerges for ten minutes after each hourly bell; hunts by sonar clicks; light hurts him. Left diaries and his "last recording".
Dr. Ruth Marrow	Lead scientist of Project Pelagic. Her notes explain the truth: "We were never listening to the future. The future was listening to us — and it learned to answer."

Character	Role
Dr. Edwin Morrow	Medical director of Project Morrow. Clinical, chilling. His tape is part 1 of the last recording.
Aldo Wren	Harbourmaster and lighthouse keeper. Logged the 1923 silence; nailed warnings ("White ring = safe", "no one in the woods when the bell strikes").
Ines Halloran	Research assistant. Mother of **Nell** (7). Her letter: "Mummy has gone down to the water with the others... Keep the white ring on the door."
The Lodger	Not a named character: if Elias stands still too long, something comes up behind him and whispers his own future words into his ear.
Drowned villagers	Pale, wet apparitions (Low Vey's dead, the Pelagic crew) that only stand where you aren't looking.

5. The world: locations in play order

Main path is marked **(M)**; optional chapters **(O)**. Chapter title cards appear on first arrival.

I. The Flooded Dock (M)

Arrival by maintenance boat. The boat radio plays Elias's own voice ("Mainland, this is Vale. I'm on the dock. There's nobody here."), then Suha's first call. Stepping onto the dock, footsteps follow him and take three more steps after he stops. The maintenance shed (white ring = safe) holds the **field recorder**, the dock log and the work order. Tutorial: Listen [Q] reveals the footsteps again with his own whispered voice beneath ("...don't let it hear you twice..."); Record [R + LMB] captures it. The boat is also where every ending's final scene plays.

II. The Abandoned Settlement (M)

Lit windows with no power; tea still warm; a chair turned to face the wall. Houses: the **teahouse** (radio announces a conversation about the station key; moments later the same conversation is heard from the blue house), the **blue house** (white ring; Nell's bed; Ines's letter; the **backwards clock** holding the **station key**), the **harbourmaster's office** (Marrow's note on replay echoes; the map of red pins), a collapsed house. A bell in the square — it rings while motionless, and **it strikes every in-game hour** (Kell's signal). The first glimpse of the Listener: standing under a lamp on the lighthouse road, gone when the lamp blinks. After the key is taken, the Listener arrives and patrols the settlement. A stone wall with a chained gate closes the lighthouse road until the endings.

III. The Weather Station (M)

Fenced compound (key opens the gate). Restore power: open the **fuel valve**, then pull the generator cord. Lights return; Suha calls again on the station radio. The office tape deck (white ring) plays **Calibration Tape 13** — only hiss, unless you **listen**: then you hear footsteps on metal and four tones: MIDDLE, LOW, HIGH, LOW. Those are *Elias's own future footsteps* between the relays. The equipment corridor's three relays (A low, B middle, C high) must be engaged in that order (**B, A, C, A**). A wrong press trips the breaker (blackout, the Listener comes toward the station) and resets — never a soft-lock. Then transmit the diagnostic report from the monitoring room: the radio answers in Elias's voice ("Don't go into the caves... It heard you coming") and **the tide pulls away from the island**, exposing the tidal shelf, the caves and Low Vey.

IV. Blackwood Forest + the Old Radio Tower (O)

Pine woods west of the settlement. Net-wrapped remains hang in the trees; Listener silhouettes stand between trunks and vanish when looked at. A notice: no one in the woods when the bell strikes the hour; if you hear clicking above you, do not move. **Kell's hut** at the base of the old radio tower (white ring) holds his two diary pages, his radio rig ("IT TALKS BACK"), a blacked-out mirror ("I DON'T LOOK LIKE ME"), tally marks counting hours, and the **floodlight switch** for the tower. North-west, a rock outcrop leads down into **the Roost**: Kell hangs asleep from the ceiling above his nest of gull bones, rope and radio valves. Noise wakes him (first a stir, then he wakes). **Taking Kell's tape** from the nest (last recording 3/3) wakes him for a chase; the only way to end it is to throw the tower floodlight, which burns him out of the sky. In the light he looks like a man again.

Kell's hourly hunt (any time he is alive): the island clock runs from 23:40 (one in-game hour every ten real minutes; press **T** for the watch). When the bell strikes, Kell leaves the roost and hunts Blackwood for ten in-game minutes. Every few seconds his sonar clicks sweep the woods; if you are **moving in the open** when a sweep passes over you, he screeches and dives. Survive by **standing still**, getting **under a roof**, or catching him in your **flashlight** (stuns him).

V. The Ship Graveyard (O)

West shore below Blackwood. The research ship **MV Pelagic** lies on her side; the boats that came looking for her are wrecked in the shallows; drowned crew stand in the surf. Inside the cargo hold: a net full of crew with their ears cut away, blood on the walls, the ship's radio log ("03:09 Crew below. Ears bleeding. Morrow's people are collecting"). Approaching the radio: it switches itself on, screams (a jumpscare), then repeats the Pelagic's **mayday** ("we hear the island answering... it is asking us to come closer"), which can be recorded (last recording 2/3).

VI. Low Vey — the submerged village (O, low tide only)

The village drowned in 1923 lies on the tidal shelf below the east cliffs, exposed only after the station transmission. Roofless cottages, a fallen church bell, a family at supper with their heads all turned toward the lighthouse, the keeper's 1923 log. Walking into the square triggers **the thirteen-second silence**: all sound stops; when it returns, seven drowned figures stand in a ring around Elias, then are gone. Low Vey sits beside the clear lane leading to the cave mouth.

VII. The Tidal Caves (M)

Reached at the end of the exposed shelf. A survey cable with yellow tags guides the way. Pre-echo splashes in still pools; footsteps from inside the rock. **Puzzle:** an iron resonance seal opens only to the "tide bell" — a drowned ship's bell in a side niche that is motionless but rings when you **listen**. Record it and **replay it into the seal's horn**. Beyond, the long gallery is patrolled by the Listener; a loose plate in a side cave bangs "when the sea breathes" — record it and replay it to send the Listener away (replayed sounds return to where they were recorded). An iron stair at the far end climbs into the lighthouse.

VIII. The Underground Research Annex — Project Morrow (O)

Through an iron door marked MORROW in the cave gallery. Flickering clinical corridor; the Listener glimpsed at its far end. **Examination room**: a dental-style chair with a headset bolted into the skull of whoever sat there, covered bodies, jars of human ears labelled by date (some dates next year). **Containment cells**: a body grown into rope and netting. **Records office** (white ring): Morrow's clinical summary and the subject list naming **Subject 13:**

E. Vale. **Morrow's tape** (last recording 1/3): taking it kills the lights and the Listener comes down the corridor — a chase to the ringed office or the ladder.

IX. The Lighthouse (M)

Entered from below through a grate. Walkable tower: ground floor (barred front door, sealed hatch), maintenance landing (+6 m) with a tape in Elias's voice ("Send it... don't trust the tape upstairs"), control room (+12 m) with a contradicting tape ("Don't listen to the other tape") and the **seal release lever**. Approaching the lever, Elias hears the hatch far below grind open *before* he pulls it; pulling it is silent. On the stairs, the Listener is glimpsed on the landing above. The beacon outside stops turning when you look straight at it. After the transmitter is armed, an iron ladder to the **lantern room** becomes usable (Suha's ending).

X. The Transmitter Chamber — "What the Tide Remembers" (M)

A circular hall beneath the lighthouse; the transmitter (coils, copper rings, glowing tubes) in the centre; the Listener patrols around it. Three power **couplings** on the walls: each one **clanks before you touch it** (pre-echo) and the Listener walks to that sound — let it look, hide behind pillars, then pull. A valve that hammers can be recorded and replayed as a lure. With all three engaged, the Listener stops and turns its head toward Elias: it is listening for the choice. Marrow's final note lies on the console. Then the choice.

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6. The endings (four)

All endings finish with the boat scene at the dock (except The Light), then an ending card.

1. **BREAK THE SIGNAL** — pull the red lever (OVERLOAD). Flash, the Listener collapses into a heap of rope, real silence; the tide returns. Walking back, Elias's footsteps happen exactly when he takes them. On the boat the radio whispers one last faint pre-echo: "...three more steps." Card: the island went silent; eleven days later a fishing boat hears footsteps on an empty dock.
2. **SEND THE WARNING** — turn the key (TRANSMIT). The mainland copies; every radio on the island answers in Elias's voice; the Listener turns away into the dark; the beacon burns brighter. On the boat the radio says his next words before he speaks them: "—it's on the boat." Card: a storm and a ferry were saved; the signal spread along the coast.
3. **THE LAST RECORDING** (secret) — only if Elias carries all three optional recordings (Morrow's tape, the Pelagic mayday, Kell's tape). A third option appears: play them into the transmitter. It "hears itself"; the Listener walks to it and collapses; the thirteen seconds play back to the machine. On the boat his recorder holds one file, thirteen seconds long. Card: ordinary silence at last.
4. **THE LIGHT (SUHA)** — after the transmitter is armed, Suha calls one last time: "None of this is real. You fell asleep on the boat. Come up to the top of the lighthouse — to the light. I'll wake you up." If Elias climbs the ladder to the lantern room instead of choosing at the console, he finds her there, her back to him, in a pale dress. She says she knew he'd come. She turns: a drowned face. The island, in her voice: "There was never anyone waiting for you, Elias. You drowned at 03:12. We only needed someone to keep the light." Card: ships still pick up a calm man on 2.182 MHz asking Suha to come up to the light. Theme: love used as a lure; betrayal.

Suha's presence through the game foreshadows ending 4: radio calls on the boat, at the station and in the chamber; soft whispers close to Elias's ear at story beats and occasionally while exploring ("Wake up, love. It's only a

dream", "I left the light on for you", "Come up to the light. I'll be waiting at the top"); and a warm figure in a pale dress that appears far off and smiles, then is gone when looked at.

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7. Mechanics (how the game plays)

Controls: WASD move · mouse look · Shift sprint (loud) · Ctrl crouch (quiet, harder to see) · Space jump · E interact/read · F flashlight · Q recorder listen · R recorder panel · LMB record/replay · wheel/Tab select recording · J journal · T watch · Esc pause · F11/Alt+Enter fullscreen.

The field recorder - *Listen (Q)*: ambience is filtered; a hidden audio layer opens (pre-echoes, the calibration tape tones, the drowned bell, the whispering under the dock footsteps). Movement is slower while listening. - *Record*: hold near a recordable sound for 2.4 s; some only exist while listening. - *Replay*: the recorder's small speaker plays the sound where Elias stands (quiet, but the Listener can hear it), then **the island returns the sound, loudly, to the place it was recorded** — the main way to lure the Listener. Replaying into a device (the seal's horn) can also solve puzzles.

Noise & stealth. Every footstep emits a noise radius: crouching ≈1.5 m, walking ≈5 m, sprinting ≈16 m; water and metal floors are louder. Doors, machines, jumping, the flashlight click, replay and pre-echoes also emit noise. Safe places are communicated by a painted **white ring** on the door.

The Listener (AI). States: Dormant, Roaming (patrol points), Investigating (walks to a heard sound, head turns first), Searching (silent, looks around ~9 s), Hunting (chases while it sees you; gives up after losing sight ~4.5 s or after ~22 s), Returning. It sees ~10 m in a 70° cone from its head (×0.45 crouched, ×1.6 with the flashlight on). It never paths through doorways and backs out of ringed rooms. Catching Elias triggers a short death sequence and a reload at the last checkpoint.

Kell (boss). Hourly emergence via the in-game clock and the settlement bell; sonar sweeps every few seconds; detection only if moving in the open within range; screech → dive (~1.3 s warning); flashlight in his face stuns him; the radio-tower floodlight kills him during the chase.

Horror systems. The Lodger (stand still ~25 s → breathing approaches from behind → a whisper in the ear; turning round in time shows a face); apparitions that exist only out of view; first-entry house scares (the chair that becomes occupied in the teahouse, the harbourmaster's door slamming and lights dying, a face at the blue house window, a figure at the station window); Listener glimpses; the thirteen-second silence; jumpscare stings used sparingly; Suha's warm presence.

Story delivery. Opening briefing cards; ten chapter title cards; **Elias's journal [J]** that fills in plain language as he learns things (why he is here, pre-echoes, the recorder, the Listener, the key, Pelagic, the tide, Low Vey, Morrow, Kell, the missing ships, the last recording, Suha, what is happening, the choice); Elias's spoken thoughts at key moments; examine points with his comments; documents (notes, logs, letters, diaries) read in a paper overlay; radio and tape scenes, all **voiced** and subtitled.

Checkpoints & saving. Progress (flags, objective, recordings, journal, clock) saves automatically at checkpoints; Continue on the main menu. Death reloads the last checkpoint.

Sound. Zone-based ambience (sea, wind, interior, caves, woods, drone, the lighthouse signal), rain with occasional thunder, a distant foghorn, surface-aware heel-and-toe footsteps, spatial 3D audio, separate buses for ambience,

effects, pre-echoes, voices and the listen-only layer. Speech is generated offline with Kokoro TTS (Elias, Suha, radio/tape voices) and always subtitled; captions for sound effects are optional.

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8. Puzzles (complete list and solutions)

#	Where	Puzzle	Solution
1	Dock shed	Recorder tutorial	Take the recorder, listen (Q), record the footsteps.
2	Settlement	Station key	The teahouse radio says the key is with "the only thing in Vey that keeps time"; the conversation repeats from the blue house: open the backwards clock.
3	Station	Power	Open the fuel valve, then pull the starter cord (without fuel it coughs and dies).
4	Station	Relay order	Listen at Tape 13 in the office: MIDDLE, LOW, HIGH, LOW → relays **B, A, C, A**. Wrong order = blackout + reset.
5	Station	Transmit	Use the monitoring console → tide goes out.
6	Caves	Resonance seal	Listen at the drowned bell, record it, replay it near the seal's horn.
7	Caves	Gallery	Sneak past the Listener, or record the loose plate and replay it to lure it away.
8	Lighthouse	Lower seal	Climb to the control room; pull the seal release; descend through the hatch.
9	Chamber	Couplings	Engage all three couplings while avoiding the Listener (each pre-echoes; lure it with the valve recording).
—	Optional	Last recording	Morrow's tape (annex), the Pelagic mayday (ship graveyard radio), Kell's tape (the Roost) — no extra puzzle.

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9. Timeline of a typical playthrough

23:40 arrival → dock and recorder → settlement and key (Listener begins patrolling) → station power, tape, relays, transmission (tide out) → optional: Blackwood/Kell, ship graveyard, Low Vey → caves and seal → optional annex → lighthouse → chamber → choice at about 03:12 story-time → boat → ending card. Length: roughly 60–90 minutes with optional content.

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10. Art & tone

Cinematic low-poly realism with weathered materials; restrained palette (blue-grey sea, cold green grass, wet charcoal stone, faded wood, amber practical lights, occasional red warning lamps); heavy but selective fog; rain; practical lights (flashlight, lamps, lit windows, the lighthouse beacon). Horror comes mostly from sound, absence and rules the player learns, with a few memorable scares and a small number of deliberate body-horror scenes (Morrow's annex, the Pelagic hold, Blackwood remains, Low Vey's supper, Kell's nest). No combat; no gore for its own sake.

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11. How the project is built (for developers)

- Engine: **Godot 4.3**, GDScript, Forward+ (Compatibility fallback works). The whole island is assembled from code at load (~3 s): `scenes/island.tscn` → `scripts/world/island.gd`.
- Autoloads: `Game` (state, flags, objectives, saves, settings, input map, clock, journal, fullscreen) and `Sound` (bus layout, ambience zones, positional sounds, pre-echo, noise events, voice lines).
- Areas, one script each in `scripts/world/areas/`: dock, settlement, station, caves, lighthouse, chamber, forest (Blackwood + radio tower + roost), graveyard, lowvey, annex. Shared systems: `horror.gd`, `immersion.gd`, `zone.gd`, `door.gd`, `interactable.gd`, `recordable.gd`, `build.gd` (geometry helpers), `props.gd`, `models.gd` (GLB loader), `terrain.gd`, `ocean.gd` (tide).
- Enemies: `scripts/enemy/listener.gd` (+ procedural model), `kell.gd` (+ Blender model).
- All text lives in `scripts/data/story.gd`: objectives, chapters, journal, Elias lines, examine comments, documents, radio/tape sequences, recordings.
- Assets: procedural textures (`tools/gen_textures.py`), procedural SFX (`tools/gen_audio.py`), Blender models (`tools/blender/build_models.py`, run with the `bpy` package), voices (`tools/export_lines.gd` + `tools/gen_voice.py`, Kokoro TTS).
- Tests: `tests/run_all.sh` runs scripted scenarios (full playthroughs for every ending, walking routes, AI, death, menus, optional chapters, Kell, horror, voices).
- Builds: `release/TheTideRemembers-windows.zip` (Windows export).